



Key Dates for the 2026 Election Cycle

Tuesday, May 5, 2026 - State and County Primary Election

Primary elections may be held for **state judicial offices and applicable county offices**, subject to the call by political parties.

Deadline to Call Primary	Monday, August 25, 2025
Deadline to Rescind Call for Primary First Day to	Friday, November 21, 2025
Pick Up Petitions	Monday, December 22, 2025 Wednesday, February
First Day to Accept Absentee Applications	4, 2026 Thursday, February 19, 2026, 12:00 Noon
Qualifying Deadline*	

**** This qualifying deadline applies to primary candidates, candidates nominated by caucus, and independent candidates for the offices on the May primary ballot.***

Withdrawal Deadline	Thursday, February 26, 2026, 12:00 Noon
Voter Registration Deadline	Monday, April 6, 2026
Early Voting Period	Wednesday, April 15 – Thursday, April 30, 2026 Saturday,
Absentee Ballot Request Deadline	April 25, 2026

Thursday, August 6, 2026 - Primary and General Election

Primary elections will be held for **Governor, U.S. Senate, U.S. House, Tennessee Senate (odd-numbered districts), Tennessee House, and Republican and Democratic State Executive Committees**. General elections will be held for **vacant state judicial offices and applicable county offices**.

First Day to Pick Up Petitions	Friday, January 9, 2026
Qualifying Deadline*	Tuesday, March 10, 2026, 12:00 Noon

**** This qualifying deadline applies to primary and independent candidates for the offices on the August primary ballot.***

Withdrawal Deadline	Tuesday, March 17, 2026, 12:00 Noon
First Day to Accept Absentee Applications Voter	Friday, May 8, 2026
Registration Deadline Early Voting	Tuesday, July 7, 2026
Early Voting Period	Friday, July 17 – Saturday, August 1, 2026
Absentee Ballot Request Deadline	Monday, July 27, 2026

Tuesday, November 3, 2026 - State and Federal General Election

All candidates (including independents) for **Governor, U.S. Senate, U.S. House, Tennessee Senate (odd-numbered districts), and Tennessee House** must follow the qualifying dates for the August election. For **municipal elections** held with the November election, the qualifying dates below apply.

First Day to Pick Up Petitions	Monday, June 22, 2026
First Day to Accept Absentee Applications	Thursday, August 5, 2026
Qualifying Deadline	Thursday, August 20, 2026, 12:00 Noon
Withdrawal Deadline	Thursday, August 27, 2026 12:00 Noon
Voter Registration Deadline	Monday, October 5, 2026
Early Voting Period	Wednesday, October 14 – Thursday, October 29, 2026
Absentee Ballot Request Deadline	Saturday, October 24, 2026